Teacher Guide Mission: Thank a Hero!



Thank you for choosing Mr. Pencil & Co! In this Veterans Day escape room, first graders help Mr. Pencil open a locked Thank-You Mailbox. Each mission they finish gives them one number of the 4-digit lock. It works as a **Google Form** or as a **no-prep printable**.

What's Inside

- **Student Printable** (10 pages): cover, mission story, reading passage, story questions, math word problems, dog tag decoder, word scramble, mailbox finale, thank-you card.
- **Answer Key**: answers at a glance, clue cards, Google Form copy-paste sheet, and filled-in student pages.
- **Google Form Auto-Builder** file and optional form pictures.
- **Terms of Use**.

The 4 Missions

1. **Reading:** a 137-word passage, "What Is Veterans Day?", with 5 questions.
2. **Math:** 6 word problems. Add and subtract within 20, compare, count by tens, add three numbers.
3. **Dog Tag Decoder:** 4 tags. A = 1, B = 2, and so on.
4. **Word Scramble:** 5 words with a picture word bank.

Timing

About **20 to 30 minutes**. Allow up to 40 minutes early in the year or if students read on their own.

Printable Version (no devices)

1. Print pages 1 to 10 in black and white. One-sided works best.
2. Read the mission story (page 2) together.
3. Students write each lock number in the box at the bottom of each mission.
4. On page 9 they write the 4 numbers in order and show you. The code is **3754**.
5. Stuck students? Read them a clue from the Clue Cards page. No clue gives the answer away.

Digital Version (Google Form)

Build the form once (page 2), then share the student link in Google Classroom. Students cannot move to the next mission until every answer is right. A wrong answer shows a friendly clue in red.

Ways to Use It

- **Whole class:** read the passage aloud, then let students solve.
- **Partners:** one reads, one writes. Switch each mission.
- **Early finishers:** page 10, the thank-you card. Mail the cards to a local veterans group.
- **Centers:** one mission per center for the week of November 11.
- **Support:** read the passage and word problems aloud. The math pictures can be counted.

Skills (Common Core)

RI.1.1, RI.1.4, RF.1.3, RF.1.4, 1.OA.A.1, 1.OA.A.2, 1.NBT.B.2c

Teacher Guide Build the Google Form



You need a free Google account. Pick **one** way. Both make the same form.

Way 1: Automatic (about 2 minutes)

1. Go to **script.google.com** and sign in. Click **New project**.
2. Delete the few lines already in the big white box.
3. Open the file **Google Form Auto-Builder.txt**. Select all of it and copy. Paste it into the white box.
4. Click the **Save** icon (a floppy disk). Then click **Run**.
5. Google asks for permission. Click **Review permissions**, pick your account, click **Advanced**, then **Go to project**, then **Allow**. You see this warning because you made the script yourself.
6. When it says "Execution completed", look in the log at the bottom. Copy the **EDIT link** (for you) and the **STUDENT link**.

Way 2: By Hand (about 15 minutes)

Keep the **Google Form Copy-Paste Sheet** (in the Answer Key) open. Paste every line from top to bottom.

1. Go to **forms.google.com** and click **Blank form**. Paste the form title and description.
2. Click the question. Change the type to **Short answer**. Paste the name question. Turn **Required** on.
3. To start a new mission, click **Add section** in the side toolbar. It looks like two stacked bars. Paste the section title and description.
4. Add each question with the **+** button. Set it to **Short answer**, paste the question, and turn **Required** on.
5. To add the choices line under a question, click the **three dots** at the bottom right and pick **Description**.
6. Click the three dots again and pick **Response validation**.
   - Letter and word answers: choose **Regular expression**, then **Matches**. Paste the pattern.
   - Math answers: choose **Number**, then **Equal to**. Type the number.
   - Paste the clue into **Custom error text**. This is the hint students see.
7. After the code question, add the last section, "You did it!".
8. Click **Settings**, then **Presentation**. Turn on **Show progress bar**. Paste the celebration line as the **Confirmation message**.

Before Students Use It

- Click the **eye** icon to preview. Type a wrong answer and check that the clue shows up.
- Optional: add the pictures from the **Google Form Images** folder. Click the image icon next to a question.
- To share, click **Send**, then the **link** icon, then **Copy**. Post the link in Google Classroom.
- Keep the edit link private. Students only get the student link.

Why it works: each answer is Required and has response validation. Google Forms will not let students click **Next** until every answer in a mission is right. The next section then shows their lock number.